

THE TIMELINE

JULY 18, 2005

During Manmohan Singh's visit to the US, the prime minister and US President George Bush announce a major civilian nuclear energy initiative.



Bush says he will seek agreement from the US Congress to enable full co-operation with India. India, on its part, would separate its civilian and military nuclear facilities in a phased manner.

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On his first-ever visit to India, President Bush and Manmohan reach an agreement on India's plans for separation of its nuclear facilities. India agrees to put 14 of its 22 reactors under civilian facilities and to work towards



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putting them under IAEA safeguards in a phased manner by 2014. US says it will ensure fuel supply for the reactors.

TERMS OF ENDEARMENT

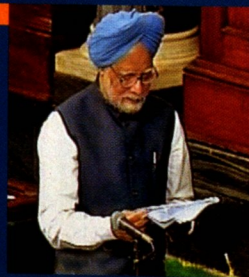
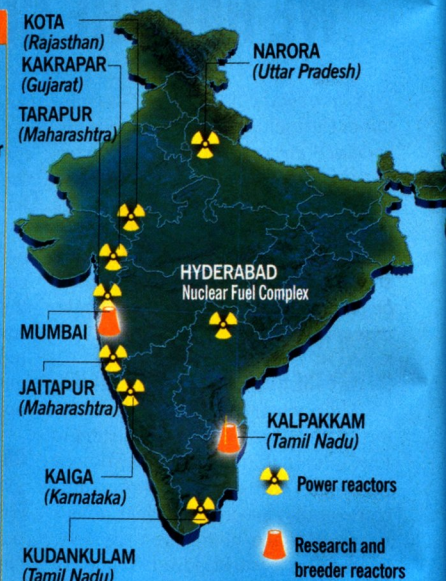
WHY THE DEAL? With energy security critical to India's growth, the deal would free up the constraints on the growth of the country's nuclear power projects by lifting the international ban on trade of such items to India.

WHAT THE US PROMISED: The US agreed to amend its laws that prevented its entities from selling civilian nuclear technology to India. It would get the 45-member Nuclear Suppliers Group to lift the ban as well. And ensure fuel supply for imported reactors.

WHAT INDIA HAS TO DO: Separate its civilian and military reactors in a phased manner and put those designated as civilian under International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards in perpetuity.

AUGUST 17, 2006

With the provisions of the Bill enabling nuclear co-operation being debated in the US Congress causing protests in India, Manmohan addresses both Houses of Parliament. He delineates aspects that India will not relax in its negotiations with the US and says it will stick to the provisions of the July 18, 2005 and March 2, 2006 agreements.



huge amounts of political capital to agree on the terms of endearment. But instead of pats on the back, they were now getting brickbats. Yet, if both are talking tough to their opponents and sticking to their guns, it comes from a quiet assurance that they had worked hard to reach an agreement that would, if it goes through in its entirety, mark a historic turning point in Indo-US relations.

Much of it had to do with the willingness of the two leaders to think out

of the box and come up with innovative solutions to overcome the nuclear issue which had been a major irritant to their relations. While Bush always seemed eager to bite the bullet on foreign policy issues, it was Manmohan who surprised everyone by his willingness to buck the system. Manmohan was 14 years older to Bush, almost a generation removed. Yet it was the personal chemistry that they developed that would see the deal through. Manmohan told INDIA TODAY: "I found

Bush a very easy person to deal with. He puts you at ease and listens carefully. He is very nice to me and of all the US presidents, he seemed the friendliest towards India." (see interview). Bush thought highly of Manmohan too. A day before the two announced the outlines of the Indo-US nuclear deal on July 18, 2005, Bush told the Indian prime minister, "Dr Singh, you are a good man. I look forward to doing business with you." The trust they enjoyed would help them overcome the deep suspicions that had dogged relations between the two countries.

Officials of the two countries had already been working hard on reaching a way of breaking the nuclear logjam. Ever since India had conducted a nu-

MANMOHAN AND HIS TEAM decided that if they were going to invest so much political capital on the deal, they wouldn't "play for peanuts" as the NDA had done.